

# Humane Animal Rescue of Pittsburgh

## Executive Summary

### Client

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## Background

Humane Animal Rescue of Pittsburgh (HARP) is one of Pennsylvania's largest animal welfare organizations, providing adoption services, veterinary care, and wildlife rehabilitation across two primary campuses. Despite its robust community presence, the organization faced challenges in managing high volumes of on-site visitor inquiries, which often diverted staff from critical operational tasks. This consulting project was initiated to design and implement a digital solution that centralizes information delivery, thereby enhancing the visitor experience and allowing staff to prioritize direct animal care and complex adoption counseling.

## Project Description

### Project Opportunity

The Project Opportunity arose from Humane Animal Rescue of Pittsburgh (HARP)'s need to reduce staff workload and improve the visitor experience by centralizing on-site information delivery. While HARP effectively used in-person conversations, printed materials, and their public website, these methods required significant real-time staff coordination, particularly during busy adoption periods. The project was an opportunity to address these conditions by consolidating fragmented information into a structured digital touchpoint specifically designed for the physical adoption environment.

### Project Vision

The Project Vision centered on creating a kiosk-specific, web-based interface optimized for touch interaction to complement existing workflows. Rather than replacing current systems like Shelterluv or Volgistics, the kiosk functioned as a centralized orientation and engagement tool. It aimed to strengthen engagement by providing accessible information on adoptions, volunteering, fostering, events, and donations, thereby increasing visitor preparedness and reducing repetitive staff explanations.

## Project Outcomes

The project resulted in a functional kiosk interface that centralizes visitor-facing information and supports staff efficiency by allowing visitors to independently access adoption, volunteer, foster, event, and donation resources. Through stakeholder feedback, workflow observation,

iterative prototyping, and usability testing, the team delivered a maintainable solution aligned with HARP's existing systems and operational needs.

## Project Deliverables

The project deliverables comprise a production-ready [web-based kiosk interface](#) optimized for touch interaction, a [GitHub repository](#) containing the complete source code, and a comprehensive technical manual detailing system architecture and maintenance procedures. These assets ensure that Humane Animal Rescue of Pittsburgh (HARP) can independently manage the kiosk and update its content via the established WordPress integration.

## Recommendations

To maximize the long-term impact of the kiosk, we recommend that HARP take four next steps. First, HARP should connect the kiosk check-in experience to Shelterluv so visitor information can be captured through an existing system rather than remaining only a visual interaction. This would make the kiosk more operationally useful by supporting follow-up, improving data consistency, and reducing manual intake work. Second, HARP should assign a content owner and establish a monthly maintenance routine to keep kiosk content, links, QR codes, and external data feeds accurate over time. Third, the organization should consider developing a mobile version of the kiosk experience so visitors can continue browsing FAQs, adoption information, and pet profiles on their own phones, especially during busy periods. Finally, a future development team could build an AI-supported pet matching questionnaire to help visitors narrow their choices and make adoption conversations more efficient. Together, these recommendations would help HARP sustain the kiosk, expand its reach, and increase its value as a visitor engagement tool.

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## Student Consulting Team

**Nick Jitjang** served as the team's technical lead and project lead. He is a third-year student majoring in Information Systems with a minor in Computer Science. He will be joining EY Technology Consulting in AI & Data after graduating from Carnegie Mellon University.

**Misty Fan** served as the team's design lead and partial project manager. She is a third-year student majoring in Information Systems with an additional major in Human-Computer Interaction and a concentration in Information Security at Carnegie Mellon University. Following the completion of her third year, she will join Evident Scientific, a Wabtec Corporation company, as a Software Development Efficiency Engineering intern.

**Scarlett Huang** served as the team's technical developer and researcher. She is a third-year student majoring in Information Systems and Computer Science. She will be heading to TikTok this summer in San Jose as a software engineer intern.